

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Shelter-in-place

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Get inside if the outdoor hazard makes travel more dangerous, and choose the room for that hazard: a lowest-floor sturdy interior area for a tornado, protective interior mass for fallout, or few outside openings for an airborne chemical release. Close openings and control ventilation only as the hazard requires. Do not remain in a burning, flooding or collapsing building, and do not wait for a message when immediate danger is visible.

Do now.

☐**Identify the hazard**

01

Read the actual shelter instruction and affected area.

☐**Choose the correct room**

02

Use an interior low room for tornadoes, a basement or central area for fallout, and the room specified for a chemical event.

☐**Bring immediate essentials**

03

Take people, pets, medicines, phone power and a radio without delaying shelter.

☐**Stay informed**

04

Remain until officials advise otherwise, unless fire or another immediate danger makes the building unsafe.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Choose the room for the hazard, not the phrase: lowest sturdy interior area for tornadoes, protective interior mass for fallout, and a room with few outside openings for an airborne chemical threat. Leave a shelter that is burning, flooding or collapsing rather than following a generic stay-inside rule.

Watch for.

Do not apply chemical room-sealing instructions to every hazard or remain in a burning building.

People & practical needs.

Keep the group together with a named adult responsible for each child or person needing assistance. Count people at every departure and arrival

Next decision.

Plan safe rooms for the hazards in your area and keep an alert source that works during outages.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Shelter-in-place · official guidance](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/shelter-in-place/>